



Maritime Southeast Asia »

*In Malay,
orangutan
means
"man of the
jungle."*

The people of the Philippines are called Filipinos and are mostly of Malay descent. It is estimated that around 25 percent of the population lives in poverty. As income is higher in the cities, many people move there in the hope of escaping poverty. However, lack of adequate housing means that many poorer families have to live in crowded slums.

Machine
replanting rice
seedlings

Mount Pinatubo erupting in 1991

RICE RESEARCH
Rice is the primary food source for half the world's population. Near Manila, in the Philippines, scientists are now experimenting with ways of creating rice plants that produce greater yields. New varieties are also being developed to grow faster, allowing farmers to harvest and replant several times during one growing season.

Oil was first discovered in Brunei in 1929. Since then, oil has also been drilled offshore. Brunei's most important natural resource has made the country very wealthy. Its people enjoy free health care and education, and pay no taxes.